Think of it like adding more trees to your forest. Once you've planted your first one, it's time to work towards your next milestone — maybe that's $5000, then $10 000, and beyond. Every dollar you add is another seed.

It doesn't have to be perfect. You don't need to know everything right now. It's about consistency: small, steady steps taken over time that led to incredible growth.

There will be ups and downs along the way. Markets move. Life happens. Priorities shift. That's normal. The key is to stay focused on the bigger picture, to track your progress at a pace that feels right for you, to check in with your goals every now and then, and to let time do its job.

Remember: Wealth is built in decades, not days. And you've already taken the hardest step: starting.

Frequently asked questions

Let's finish this chapter with answers to some of the most frequently asked questions.

'Should I invest if I have debt?'

This is a big one. You'll often hear finance experts debate whether or not you should invest while you still have debt. Some say no, you should focus on clearing any 'bad' debt first, which usually means high-interest debts like credit cards, personal loans or buy-now-pay-later services. The logic is that the guaranteed 'return' of paying off high-interest debt is better than the potential (and sometimes uncertain) returns of investing.

On the other hand, some people start small with investing while still managing low-interest debts, like a home loan or student loan, especially if they're building good money habits and learning. There's no one-size-fits-all answer, it's about balance, and sometimes getting started with a small amount can build momentum without taking your focus off debt reduction. My personal preference is that if the debt interest rate is close to above 7 per cent, pay off the debt first.